

ISO 9001:2015 Quality Management System Auditor

- Documented information -



The QMS documentation has to include:

- Documented information requested by ISO 9001 (whenever the standard says maintain or retain documented information).
- Documented information determined by the organization as being necessary for the effectiveness of the quality management system.

Size of documented information depends on:

- size and complexity of operations and processes,
- legal and regulatory requirements applicable and
- competence of personnel

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Creating & updating:

- Identification and description
- Format
- Review and approval.

Control of documented information to ensure:

- it is available in a suitable format whenever needed;
- it is adequately protected.

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Control of documented information:

- distribution, access, retrieval and use
- storage and preservation
- control of changes
- retention and disposition

External origin documents may include – documented information from customers, external providers, legal and regulatory requirements, standards, guides – any documented information that has not been created by the organization and that is needed for the planning and operation of the QMS. It should be identified and protected similar to the documented information elaborated internally.

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AUDITING

Documented information required to be maintained specifically by the standard: scope, quality policy, quality objectives

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Documented information it has considered necessary to maintain to ensure the effectiveness of its management system (like manuals, procedures, instructions, etc)

Responsibilities for reviewing and approving documented information have been assigned?

How documented information is controlled: storage, protection, access, retrieval, use, distribution, control of changes, retention periods, disposing of obsolete documents.

Usually this requirement is not evaluated as stand-alone. Documented information maintained or retained is evaluated while other requirements are being audited.